INSTRUCTOR'S DISCUSSION GUIDE

Topic 1: Introduction to Networking and Network Architecture

Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.

Curriculum: Networking 1

Excluded: Title (Slide 1), Objectives (Slide 2), and Summary (Final Slide)

Total Discussion Units: 19 Slides

Slide 3 of 22

What Is a Computer Network?

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

A computer network is a system of two or more connected devices that exchange data and share resources. Wired or wireless links carry the data using agreed communication rules called protocols.

- Connected devices: computers, phones, servers, and printers can all participate in a network; the devices do not have to be identical.
- Communication: a device sends data through a connection, and another device receives and interprets it using compatible communication rules.
- Shared access: connected users can exchange messages, use shared files, or send work to a network printer. A local network can provide these services without Internet access.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Connected devices: computers, phones, servers, and printers can all participate in a network; the devices do not have to be identical.
- Communication: a device sends data through a connection, and another device receives and interprets it using compatible communication rules.
- Shared access: connected users can exchange messages, use shared files, or send work to a network printer.
- A local network can provide these services without Internet access.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of what is a computer network?.

Key Takeaway: A computer network is a system of two or more connected devices that exchange data and share resources. Wired or wireless links carry the data using agreed communication rules called protocols.

Slide 4 of 22

Everyday Uses of Networks

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Networks let people communicate and use services hosted on other devices. Messaging, online learning, shared files, and shared printers are familiar examples.

- Messaging: a phone sends a message to another person through a connected service.
- Online learning: a student accesses course materials hosted by a school or Internet service.
- Shared resources: several computers use the same printer or store files on a shared host.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Messaging: a phone sends a message to another person through a connected service.
- Online learning: a student accesses course materials hosted by a school or Internet service.
- Shared resources: several computers use the same printer or store files on a shared host.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of everyday uses of networks.

Key Takeaway: Networks let people communicate and use services hosted on other devices. Messaging, online learning, shared files, and shared printers are familiar examples.

Slide 5 of 22

Basic Network Components

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

A network combines end devices, connecting devices, and links. These create or receive data, provide paths, and carry signals between devices.

- End devices create or receive data: computers, phones, servers, and printers.
- Connecting devices provide paths: a switch joins local wired devices, a wireless access point connects wireless devices, and a router joins networks.
- Links carry signals: Ethernet cables, optical fiber, and wireless radio connect compatible interfaces.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

☀️ REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- End devices create or receive data: computers, phones, servers, and printers.
- Connecting devices provide paths: a switch joins local wired devices, a wireless access point connects wireless devices, and a router joins networks.
- Links carry signals: Ethernet cables, optical fiber, and wireless radio connect compatible interfaces.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of basic network components.

Key Takeaway: A network combines end devices, connecting devices, and links. These create or receive data, provide paths, and carry signals between devices.

Slide 6 of 22

How Devices Connect

SIMULATION

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Wired connections carry signals through a cable. Wireless connections carry signals over radio between compatible devices.

Interactive Demonstration: `introConnections` — Use on-screen controls to step through or demonstrate the concept visually.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Wired connections carry signals through a cable.
- Wireless connections carry signals over radio between compatible devices.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of how devices connect.

Key Takeaway: Wired connections carry signals through a cable. Wireless connections carry signals over radio between compatible devices.

Slide 7 of 22

Local Network vs. Internet

SIMULATION

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

A local network connects nearby devices so they can share data and resources. Internet access connects that network to services on other networks around the world.

Interactive Demonstration: `introConnectivity` — Use on-screen controls to step through or demonstrate the concept visually.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- A local network connects nearby devices so they can share data and resources.
- Internet access connects that network to services on other networks around the world.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of local network vs. internet.

Key Takeaway: A local network connects nearby devices so they can share data and resources. Internet access connects that network to services on other networks around the world.

Slide 8 of 22

Five Elements of Data Communication

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Data communication involves a sender, receiver, message, medium, and protocol. Together, these explain who exchanges data, what travels, how it travels, and which rules make it understandable.

- Sender: the device originating a message.
- Receiver: the intended destination of the message.
- Message: the data being exchanged.
- Medium: the physical or wireless path carrying the message.
- Protocol: rules for formatting, addressing, and exchanging the message. Both sides must support compatible rules.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Sender: the device originating a message.
- Receiver: the intended destination of the message.
- Message: the data being exchanged.
- Medium: the physical or wireless path carrying the message.
- Protocol: rules for formatting, addressing, and exchanging the message.
- Both sides must support compatible rules.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of five elements of data communication.

Key Takeaway: Data communication involves a sender, receiver, message, medium, and protocol. Together, these explain who exchanges data, what travels, how it travels, and which rules make it understandable.

Slide 9 of 22

Example: one printer, five connected computers

EXAMPLE

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Five computers can share one network printer through a switch. Each device has its own connection, allowing print requests and replies to travel through the local network.

- Computer 3 sends a document through the switch to the network printer.
- The computer is the sender, the printer is the receiver, and the print data is the message. Ethernet cables carry the exchange.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Computer 3 sends a document through the switch to the network printer.
- The computer is the sender, the printer is the receiver, and the print data is the message.
- Ethernet cables carry the exchange.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of example: one printer, five connected computers.

Key Takeaway: Five computers can share one network printer through a switch. Each device has its own connection, allowing print requests and replies to travel through the local network.

Slide 10 of 22

A Simple Data Exchange

SIMULATION

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

A request asks another device to provide information or a service. When that device replies, it becomes the sender and the original requester becomes the receiver.

Interactive Demonstration: `introExchange` — Use on-screen controls to step through or demonstrate the concept visually.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- One computer requests a shared document and another responds.
- Sender and receiver roles change when the reply travels back.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of a simple data exchange.

Key Takeaway: A request asks another device to provide information or a service. When that device replies, it becomes the sender and the original requester becomes the receiver.

Slide 11 of 22

Three Benefits of Networking

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Networking makes resources, information, and services available to multiple users. Sharing, collaboration, and managed backups help people work together more efficiently.

- Resource sharing: devices can use shared printers, storage, and an Internet connection.
- Collaboration: people exchange documents and work with shared information.
- Centralized backups: managed copies reduce scattered files and support recovery.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Resource sharing: devices can use shared printers, storage, and an Internet connection.
- Collaboration: people exchange documents and work with shared information.
- Centralized backups: managed copies reduce scattered files and support recovery.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of three benefits of networking.

Key Takeaway: Networking makes resources, information, and services available to multiple users. Sharing, collaboration, and managed backups help people work together more efficiently.

Slide 12 of 22

Two Risks of Networking

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Shared access can expose information when permissions are poorly controlled. Shared equipment can also affect many users when it fails.

- Security exposure: an improperly exposed share can reveal data or permit unwanted changes.
- Shared failures: a failed central device or service can affect many connected users.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Security exposure: an improperly exposed share can reveal data or permit unwanted changes.
- Shared failures: a failed central device or service can affect many connected users.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of two risks of networking.

Key Takeaway: Shared access can expose information when permissions are poorly controlled. Shared equipment can also affect many users when it fails.

Slide 13 of 22

Two Performance Measures: Bandwidth vs Latency

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Bandwidth describes how much data a link can carry per second. Latency describes delay, so a high-capacity connection can still feel slow when responses take time.

- Bandwidth: the capacity of a link, usually measured in bits per second.
- Latency: the time delay in communication. A high-capacity link may still have high delay.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Bandwidth: the capacity of a link, usually measured in bits per second.
- Latency: the time delay in communication.
- A high-capacity link may still have high delay.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of two performance measures: bandwidth vs latency.

Key Takeaway: Bandwidth describes how much data a link can carry per second. Latency describes delay, so a high-capacity connection can still feel slow when responses take time.

Slide 14 of 22

Four network coverage types

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Network coverage describes the geographic scope of connected devices and sites. Personal, local, metropolitan, and wide area networks differ in scope rather than following universal distance cutoffs.

- Personal Area Network (PAN): devices around a person, such as a phone and Bluetooth headset.
- Local Area Network (LAN): a room, building, or local campus network, including a wireless Local Area Network (LAN).
- Metropolitan Area Network (MAN): interconnects sites across a metropolitan area.
- Wide Area Network (WAN): spans wider regions, often using carrier links. The Internet interconnects many networks.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌞 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Personal Area Network (PAN): devices around a person, such as a phone and Bluetooth headset.
- Local Area Network (LAN): a room, building, or local campus network, including a wireless Local Area Network (LAN).
- Metropolitan Area Network (MAN): interconnects sites across a metropolitan area.
- Wide Area Network (WAN): spans wider regions, often using carrier links.
- The Internet interconnects many networks.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of four network coverage types.

Key Takeaway: Network coverage describes the geographic scope of connected devices and sites. Personal, local, metropolitan, and wide area networks differ in scope rather than following universal distance cutoffs.

Slide 15 of 22

Personal Area Network (PAN)

EXAMPLE

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

A Personal Area Network connects devices around one person. It usually covers a short range and can use Bluetooth or wired connections.

- The phone sends audio to the headset over Bluetooth.
- These devices form a network around one person; this does not require an Internet connection.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- The phone sends audio to the headset over Bluetooth.
- These devices form a network around one person; this does not require an Internet connection.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of personal area network (pan).

Key Takeaway: A Personal Area Network connects devices around one person. It usually covers a short range and can use Bluetooth or wired connections.

Slide 16 of 22

Local Area Network (LAN)

EXAMPLE

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

A Local Area Network connects devices within a limited area, such as a room, building, or campus. It lets those devices exchange data and share resources through wired or wireless links.

- Each of the five computers and the printer has its own Ethernet cable to the switch: six occupied switch ports.
- The computers can send print jobs to the reachable printer. Internet access is unnecessary for this local exchange.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Each of the five computers and the printer has its own Ethernet cable to the switch: six occupied switch ports.
- The computers can send print jobs to the reachable printer.
- Internet access is unnecessary for this local exchange.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of local area network (lan).

Key Takeaway: A Local Area Network connects devices within a limited area, such as a room, building, or campus. It lets those devices exchange data and share resources through wired or wireless links.

Slide 17 of 22

Metropolitan Area Network (MAN)

EXAMPLE

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

A Metropolitan Area Network connects networks across a city or metropolitan area. It can link sites such as library branches, municipal offices, or campuses within that area.

- A city-operated network interconnects library branches across a metropolitan area.
- Each branch also has its own local network; the city links connect those separate sites.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- A city-operated network interconnects library branches across a metropolitan area.
- Each branch also has its own local network; the city links connect those separate sites.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of metropolitan area network (man).

Key Takeaway: A Metropolitan Area Network connects networks across a city or metropolitan area. It can link sites such as library branches, municipal offices, or campuses within that area.

Slide 18 of 22

Wide Area Network (WAN)

EXAMPLE

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

A Wide Area Network connects networks across large geographic areas, such as regions or countries. Organizations commonly use provider services to link their distant sites.

- A provider service joins campuses in different regions. Routers connect the campus networks to that service.
- The wide-area link joins local networks; it does not replace their local switches or wireless access points.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- A provider service joins campuses in different regions.
- Routers connect the campus networks to that service.
- The wide-area link joins local networks; it does not replace their local switches or wireless access points.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of wide area network (wan).

Key Takeaway: A Wide Area Network connects networks across large geographic areas, such as regions or countries. Organizations commonly use provider services to link their distant sites.

Slide 19 of 22

Two network service architectures

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Network architecture describes which devices request and provide services. Peer-to-peer and client-server arrangements can both operate within the same geographic network type.

- Peer-to-peer: peers can both request and provide resources, such as one Personal Computer (PC) sharing a folder with another.
- Client-server: clients request services from dedicated service providers, such as a school file server.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Peer-to-peer: peers can both request and provide resources, such as one PC sharing a folder with another.
- Client-server: clients request services from dedicated service providers, such as a school file server.
- One Local Area Network (LAN) can use both architectures.
- A server is a role, not simply a large or expensive computer.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of two network service architectures.

Key Takeaway: Network architecture describes which devices request and provide services. Peer-to-peer and client-server arrangements can both operate within the same geographic network type.

Slide 20 of 22

P2P vs Client-Server Availability

SIMULATION

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

A shared resource is available only while its host and required connection are working. Peer-hosted files depend on their individual owners, while centralized files depend on the server.

Interactive Demonstration: `availabilityDemo` — Use on-screen controls to step through or demonstrate the concept visually.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Compare the same shared files when a peer or the central server goes offline.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of p2p vs client-server availability.

Key Takeaway: A shared resource is available only while its host and required connection are working. Peer-hosted files depend on their individual owners, while centralized files depend on the server.

Slide 21 of 22

Two link choices: wired and wireless

CONCEPT

📖 WHAT TO READ & DISPLAY ON SCREEN

Wired links carry signals through a physical cable, while wireless links use radio. One network can combine both methods without changing its geographic classification.

- Ethernet provides a cabled link with predictable interference characteristics and a physical port requirement.
- Wi-Fi provides radio access and mobility; walls, interference, distance, and shared airtime affect performance.

💡 BRIEF EXPLANATION AFTER READING (TEACHER'S DISCUSSION NOTES)

🌟 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY / INTUITION

> *Discover everyday networking, classify network coverage and architectures, and follow a simple exchange between devices.*

🗣️ HOW TO EXPLAIN IT (TALKING POINTS)

- Ethernet provides a cabled link with predictable interference characteristics and a physical port requirement.
- Wi-Fi provides radio access and mobility; walls, interference, distance, and shared airtime affect performance.
- Neither medium is automatically secure.
- Use authentication, encryption, and appropriate access controls.

❓ QUICK CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING (ASK THE CLASS)

Teacher Asks: "Ask the class: Why is this concept essential when setting up or troubleshooting a modern network?"

Expected Answer / Guidance: Encourages learners to explain the functional role and real-world impact of two link choices: wired and wireless.

Key Takeaway: Wired links carry signals through a physical cable, while wireless links use radio. One network can combine both methods without changing its geographic classification.